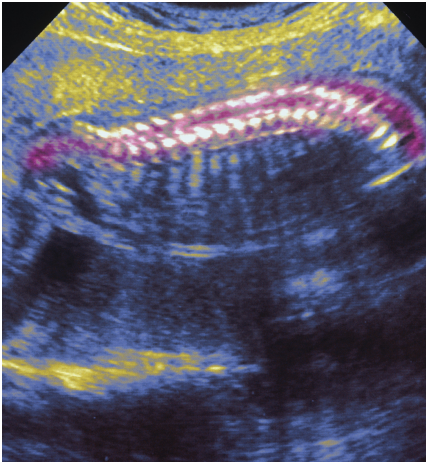




YOU ARE **22 WEEKS EXACTLY**
126 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The vertebrae that make up your baby's spinal column encircle and protect the spinal cord. The vertebrae are seen here on an ultrasound scan, forming a long chain (white areas) that narrows at the base of the spine and ends with a slight outward curve.

“Maintaining a professional manner at work will set the standard for how colleagues treat you during pregnancy.”

Chances are that everyone in your office will be aware that you are expecting a baby by this stage, even if you haven't told them personally. Good news does have a habit of traveling fast, and you may have that pregnancy “glow” that makes your condition pretty clear—as well as a fairly prominent belly.

If word of your pregnancy is getting around the office, it might be best to tell your boss now. It's always better and more professional if your boss hears this news before other people in your company.

You may need to adapt your working day a little, but play it carefully. Try to keep up with your work, and act professionally. Your colleagues are, hopefully, thrilled that you're pregnant, but try not to expect special favors or extra attention.

While being pregnant isn't an illness, do take adequate breaks to recharge your batteries, or work flexible hours, if that's an option, so that you can avoid traveling at the busiest times.

Take regular breaks for gentle exercise and to get some fresh air, drink plenty of water, and eat smaller amounts more frequently to keep your energy levels high.

ASK A DOCTOR

My manager said I can't have time off to go to my prenatal doctor appointments. What should I do? You'll be spending a lot of time at the doctor's office for prenatal care during the next several months—every 4 weeks now, but as frequently as once a week at the end of your pregnancy. If you also work full-time, it's a good idea to schedule your prenatal appointments for the early morning, before you begin work, or during your lunch hour. If your appointments tend to run long or your doctor's office is far from work and your boss isn't understanding, ask if you should use your sick leave or your vacation time for the hours that you'll be away from the office.

VAGINAL BLEEDING
